



Bahirdar University

Individual Assignment: Operating System Installation.

Calculate-Linux-Installation-Project



Name: Bezawit Tesfaye

ID : 1701703

Section : A

Submitted to: mr. wendimu

Submitted Date: 29/08/2018

Contents

page

1.Introduction.....	3
2.Objectives	5
3.Requirements	6
.Hardware	6
.Softwarfe.....	7
4.Installation steps	8
5.Issues(problem faced)	17
6.Solution	18
8.Filesystem support	19
9.Advantage and disadvantage	20
10.conclusion.....	22
11.Future outlook /recommendation.....	23
12Vertualization.....	25
13.Reference	27

1. Introduction

1.1 Background of Calculate Linux

Calculate Linux is a professional Gentoo-based distribution designed for rapid deployment in both corporate and educational environments. While many Linux distributions focus solely on user friendliness Calculate Linux maintains a unique balance by providing the power and optimization of Gentoo while offering a user friendly binary installation process.

Originating from a philosophy of optimized stability Calculate Linux utilizes the Portage package management system which allows for extreme customization of the kernel and software. It is specifically engineered to be backward compatible with Gentoo but simplified through the Calculate Utilities which I utilized during this installation project to configure the system hardware and user profiles efficiently.

1.2 The Motivation Behind the Creation of Calculate Linux

The primary motivation for the creation of Calculate Linux was to bridge the gap between the high-performance capabilities of Gentoo Linux and the need for rapid, user-friendly deployment in professional environments. Before Calculate Linux, using Gentoo required hours or even days of manual compiling which was not practical for businesses or schools. The developers were motivated by three specific goals:

- ❖ **Optimization Without Complexity** The original creators wanted to maintain the Rolling Release model and the Portage package system of Gentoo which allows a computer to stay updated forever without reinstalling while removing the complexity of a manual installation. The motivation was to provide a pre-compiled system that works immediately upon installation.
- ❖ **Centralized Administration (The Calculate Utilities)** A major driving force was the need for a system that could be managed easily across many computers. This led to the development of the Calculate Utilities. These tools were motivated by the desire to allow an administrator to configure server settings, user accounts, and network permissions from a single point making it an ideal choice for a technical hub or a university lab.

- ❖ **Efficient Resource Management** The developers were motivated to create an operating system that could run smoothly on varied hardware. By optimizing the kernel to be lightweight they ensured that Calculate Linux could provide high performance even when running in virtualized environments with limited resources such as the 4GB RAM allocation used in this project.

1.3 The Fundamental Role of the Operating System

The Operating System(OS)serves as the most critical software layer in computer architecture. It functions as a complex resource manager that sits between the physical hardware and the end-user applications. Its primary responsibility is to abstract the hardware's complexity, providing a stable environment where software can execute instructions, manage memory allocation, and handle input/output operations. In essence the OS is the brain or soul of computer that ensures the CPU, RAM, and storage devices work in perfect harmony to fulfill user requests.

1.4 Project Scope and System Selection

This project documents the end-to-end installation and configuration of Calculate Linux, a powerful distribution based on the Gentoo project. The choice of Calculate Linux was intentional it provides a balance between user friendly pre configurations and the deep technical flexibility required for a professional-grade operating system. Throughout this assignment I have explored the practicalities of system deployment, ranging from initial boot configurations to the final optimization of the user interface.

1.5 Virtualization and Architecture

A significant portion of this project was conducted using Virtualization technology. By utilizing Oracle VM VirtualBox, which is classified as a Type2 hypervisor I was able to create an isolated Guest environment. This architectural setup is crucial for several reasons:

- ❖ **Encapsulation:** It allows the Linux system to run its own Kernel and manage its own virtual hardware without interfering with the host Windows system.
- ❖ **Resource Allocation:** It provides a hands-on look at how a hypervisor partitions physical CPU cycles and RAM to satisfy the needs of the virtualized environment.

- ❖ **Risk Mitigation:** It provides a safe sandbox to test critical system changes, such as modifying the ext4 journaling filesystem or adjusting boot parameters, without risking a total system failure on the physical machine.

1.6 System Calls and Models

this report addresses the critical boundary between the user and the hardware the System Call Interface. Because an Operating System must maintain security and stability it operates in two distinct modes:- User Mode (where applications run with limited privileges) and Kernel Mode (where the OS has full control over the hardware).

When an application needs to perform a privileged task such as writing to a disk or opening a network connection it must issue a System Call. In the context of this assignment I examine the implementation of `strgid()` analyzing how this request serves as a secure bridge that allows the CPU to switch context from the restricted user space to the powerful kernel space.

2. Objectives

2.1 General Objective

The primary goal of this assignment is to move beyond theoretical classroom concepts and gain hands on proficiency in the deployment of a professional-grade Operating System. By installing and configuring Calculate Linux I aim to develop a deep practical understanding of how a modern OS manages hardware resources ensures data security through robust filesystems and facilitates critical communication between user applications and the system kernel.

2.2 Specific Objectives

- **Mastery of Virtualization Environments:** To successfully deploy a Type 2 Hypervisor using VirtualBox. The goal is to learn how to segment my physical computer's power specifically the CPU and RAM to create a stable isolated environment where a guest OS can thrive without compromising the host system.
- **Deep-Dive into Linux Filesystem Architecture:** To implement the ext4 (Fourth Extended Filesystem). My objective is to understand the mechanics of Journaling, specifically how it acts as a fail safe to protect system integrity and prevent data corruption during unexpected power loss or system crashes.
- **Analysis of the Kernel-User Interface:** To explore the privileged layers of the CPU. I aim to clearly define the boundary between User Mode and kernel

Mode, demonstrating how System Calls like `stgrid()` act as a secure, controlled bridge that allows ordinary programs to safely request services from the system's core.

- **Advanced Troubleshooting and Problem Solving:** To treat every installation error (such as bootloader failures or partition conflicts) as a learning opportunity. My objective is to document these challenges and their solutions, showing a professional ability to debug complex technical environments.
- **Optimization and System Hardening:** To go beyond a basic installation by configuring the Calculate Linux environment for efficiency. This includes managing software repositories, optimizing system boot times, and ensuring that the final environment is a productive workspace for development tasks.

3. System Requirements

For a successful installation of CalculateLinux within a virtualized environment specific technical requirements had to be met. These requirements ensure that the Guest OS has enough resources to run smoothly without crashing the Host computer.

3.1 Hardware Requirements

The physical resources of my computer were partitioned to support the virtual machine. Below are the minimum and allocated specifications used for this project:

Hardware Component	Allocation / Specification	Purpose in Project
Processor (CPU)	2 Cores (2.4 GHz+)	To handle the Linux Kernel threads and process execution.

Memory (RAM)	4 GB	To provide enough space for switching between User and Kernel modes.
Virtual Storage	25 GB (VDI)	To host the root directory and manage the ext4 filesystem partitions.
Video Memory	128 MB	To ensure the Graphic User Interface (GUI) renders smoothly without lag.
Network Adapter	NAT / Bridged	To allow the guest OS to communicate with the internet for system updates.

3.2 Software Requirements

The following software stack was used to build, install, and document the operating system environment:

- ✓ **Host Operating System:** Windows 10/11 (The primary environment that hosts the virtualization).
- ✓ **Hypervisor (Virtualization Software):** Oracle VM VirtualBox This is the Type 2 Hypervisor that allows the hardware to be shared between two different systems.
- ✓ **Guest Operating System:** Calculate Linux (ISO Image). This is the Gentoo-based distribution selected for the installation.
- ✓ **Filesystem Utility:** ext4 (Fourth Extended Filesystem). This was used during the partitioning phase to provide Journaling support for data safety.
- ✓ **Documentation Tools:** Microsoft Word for professional report formatting and Snipping Tool for capturing evidence of the installation.

Selecting these requirements was a deliberate process to balance performance and stability. By dedicating 4GB of RAM and dual CPU cores I ensured that Calculate Linux has sufficient overhead to perform complex System Calls without bottlenecking the host machine. Furthermore using a Type 2 Hypervisor like VirtualBox provides a crucial layer of abstraction allowing for deep level

experimentation with the ext4 filesystem in a completely secure sandboxed environment.

4. Installation Process

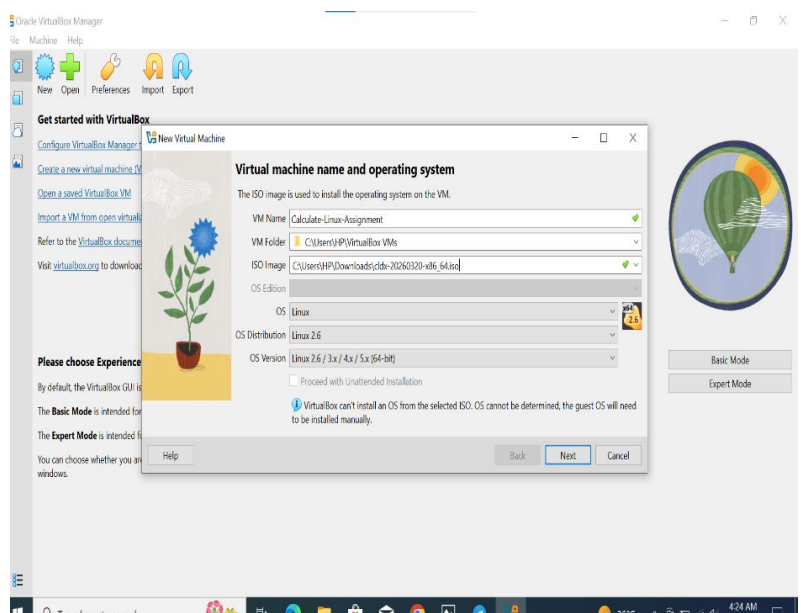
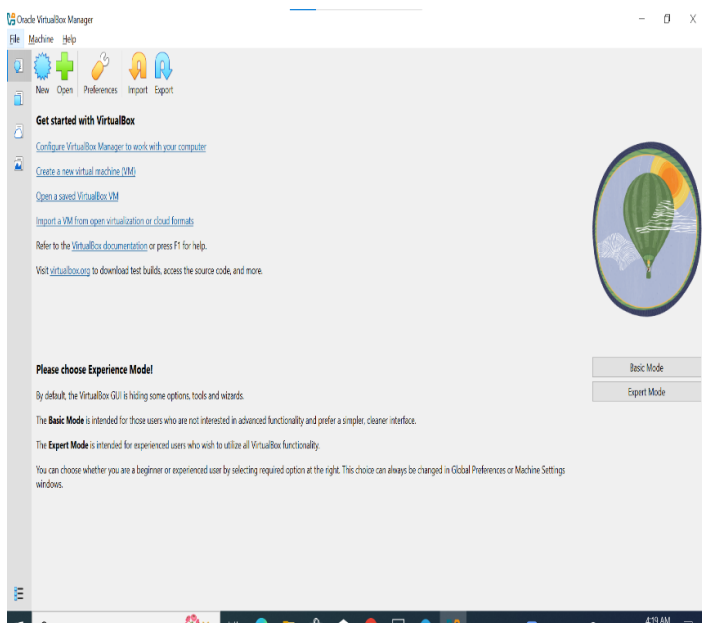
The installation of Calculate Linux was performed using a virtualized environment to ensure a controlled and safe deployment. This process was divided into two phases:- the creation of the virtual hardware and the configuration of the operating system.

Step 1: Creating the Virtual Environment

Before installing the software I had to build a Virtual Computer (the Virtual Machine).

- Action: I download on chrome and opened Oracle VM VirtualBox and created a new machine named Calculate_Linux_Assignment.

The Logic: I selected Gentoo (64-bit) as the version type. This is a critical technical step because Calculate Linux is built on the Gentoo stage3 archive. Choosing the correct architecture ensures the Kernel can communicate properly with the virtual CPU.



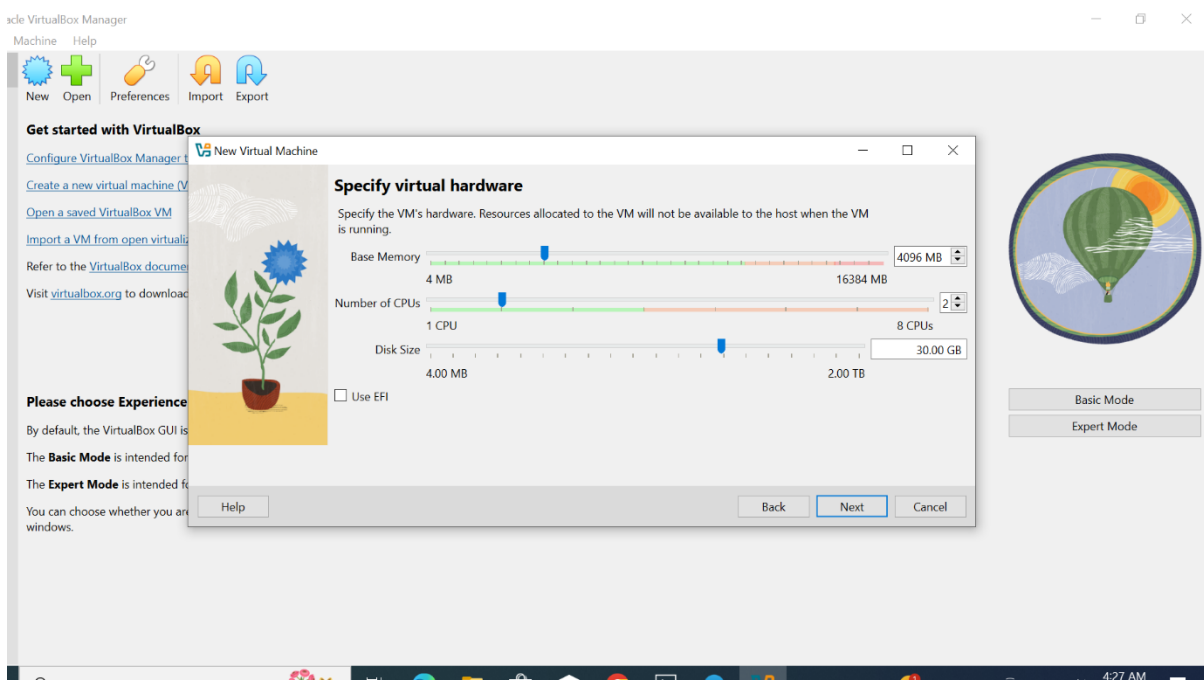
Step 2: Memory Allocation

I dragged the slider to 4096 MB (4 GB). This provides enough User Space memory so the Kernel doesn't bottleneck during the install.

Step 3: Creating the 30 GB Hard Disk

I selected Create a virtual hard disk now and chose VDI.

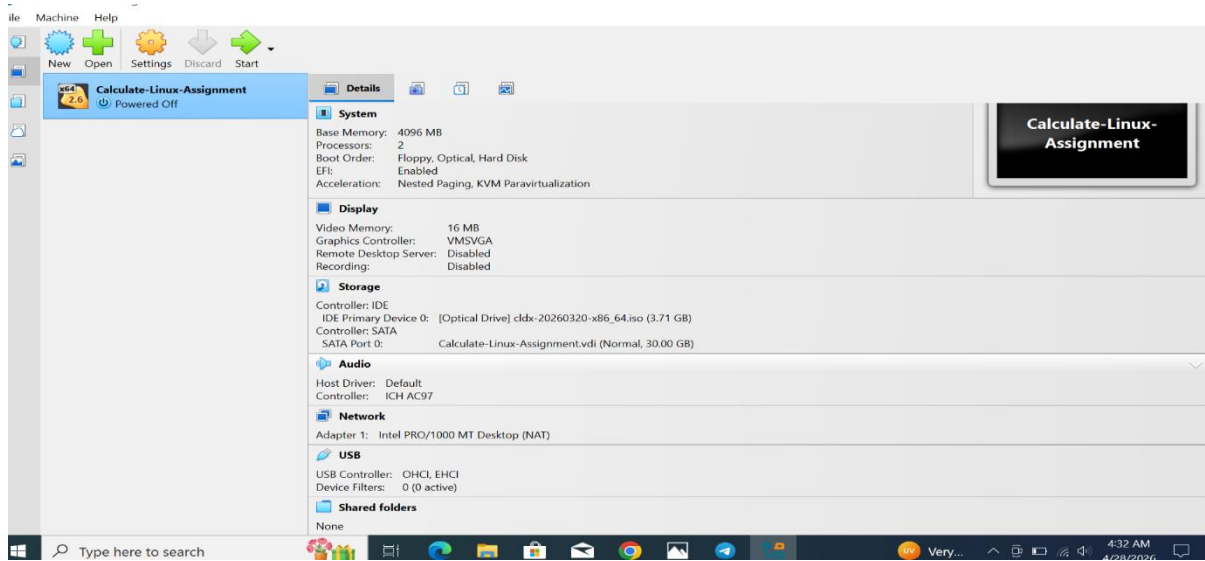
- The Action: I manually typed 30 GB into the size box.
- The Logic: This 30 GB is the Physical limit the OS will see. It is plenty of space for the ext4 partitions.



Step 4: Inserting the ISO

- The Problem: A new VM is like a computer with no disk inside. It is empty.
- What I did: I clicked Settings then the Storage tab. I clicked the word Empty (next to the silver CD icon). On the right side I clicked the small Blue Disk icon and chose my Calculate Linux ISO file.

- The Result: This plugs in the installer so the VM has something to boot from.



Step 5: Starting the Machine

I clicked the green Start arrow. A small window appeared asking to Select startup disk I made sure my ISO was selected and clicked Start.

Step 6: The Boot Loader Menu

A black screen with a list appeared.

- Action: I selected Calculate Linux Desktop and pressed Enter.

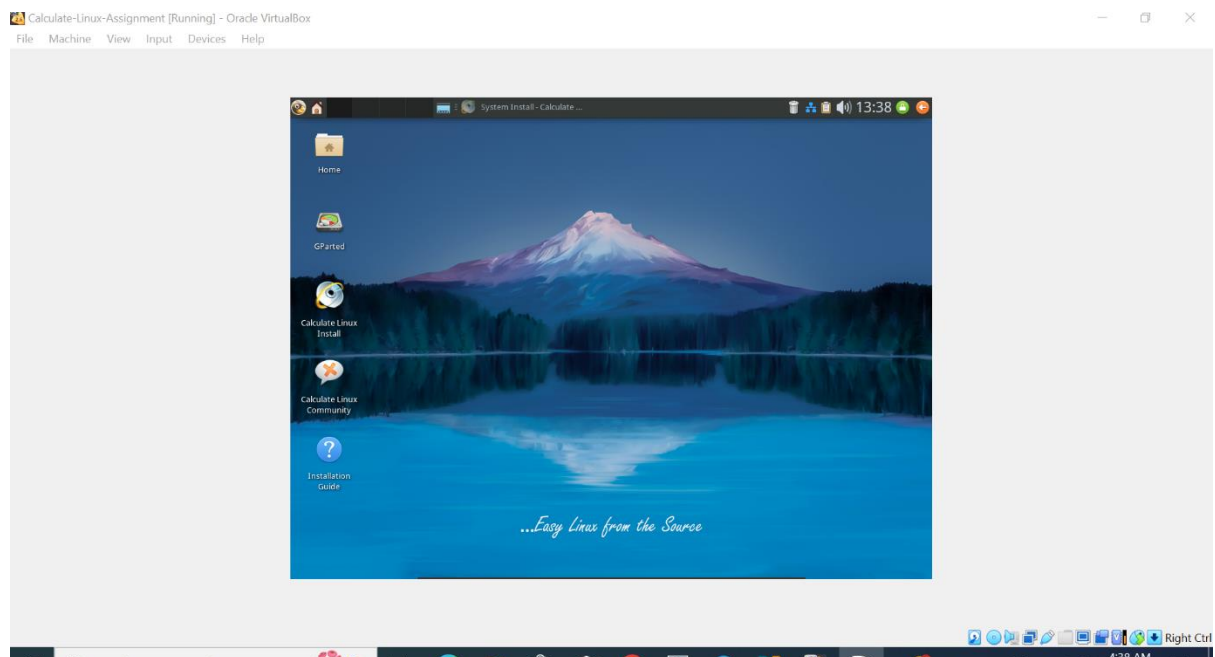
Step 7: The System Loading

I faced a screen with many lines of white text moving quickly.

- The Logic: This is the Kernel probing the virtual hardware (CPU, RAM, Disk) to make sure everything is compatible before the Desktop starts.

Step 8: Entering the Live Desktop

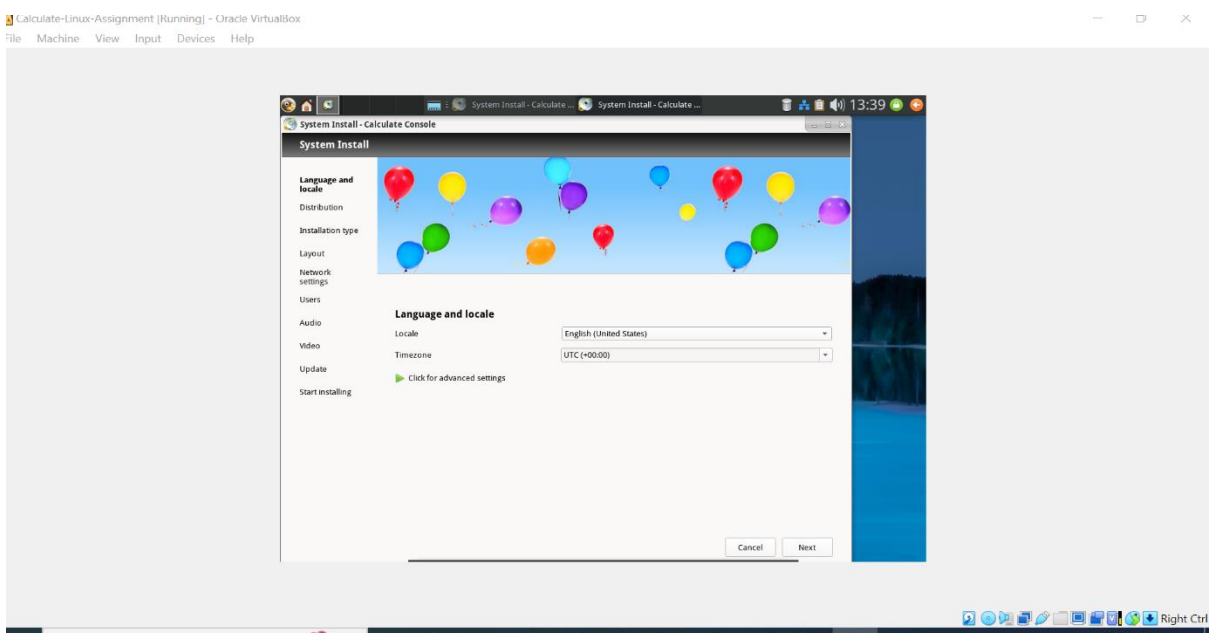
The screen turned into a colorful desktop. I moved my mouse and Double clicked the icon on the desktop labeled Calculate Linux Install.



Step 9: Language and locale

The installer opened I selected my language and keyboard layout so I could type my passwords correctly later.

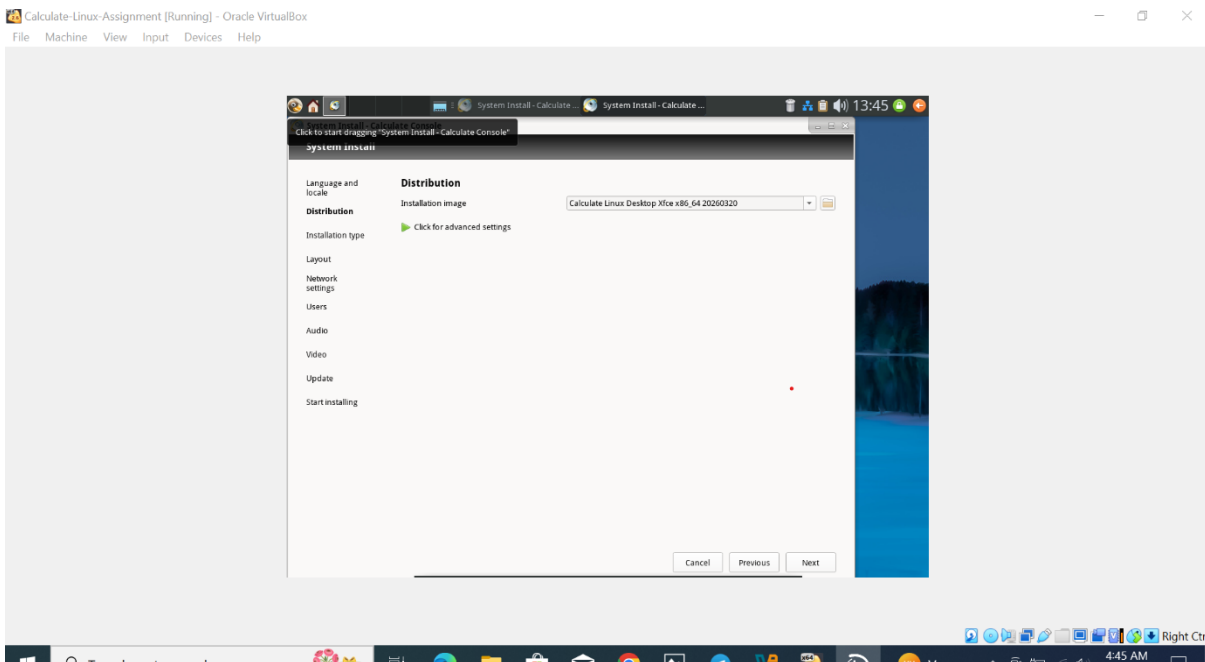
Step 10: Timezone Selection I clicked my location on the world map. This synchronizes the System Clock which is vital for security certificates.



Step10.Distribution

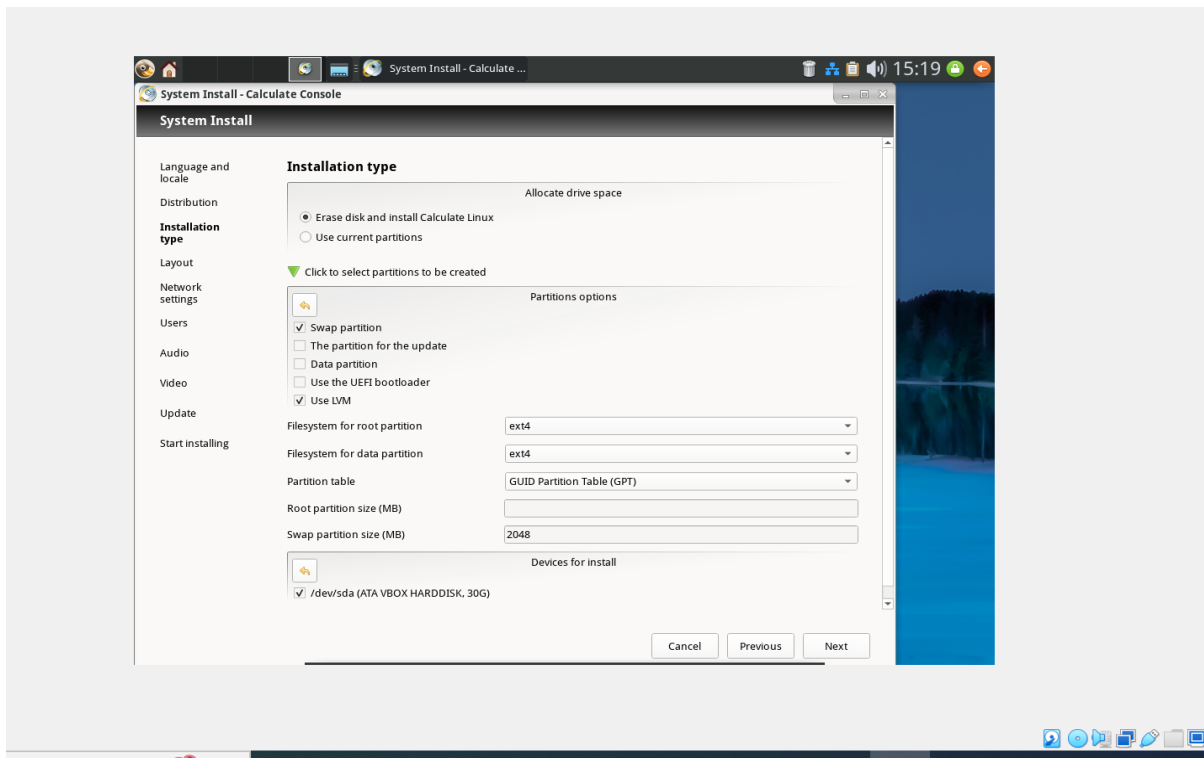
- What I faced: Confirming the OS version.
- The Logic: I verified the distribution to ensure I was installing the Binary version of the desktop. In Gentoo systems choosing the right distribution

profile determines whether your system is optimized for stability or the latest bleeding edge features.



Step11. Installation Type

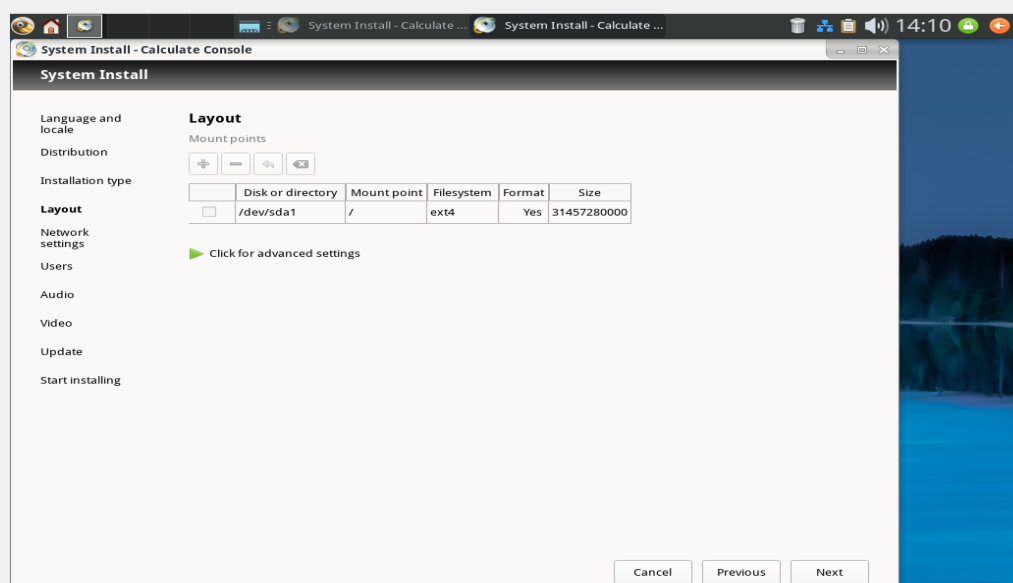
- What I did: Selected Erase disk and opened the Advanced Partition settings.
- The Logic: GPT & UEFI:- I chose GPT over the old MBR because it's more robust and supports larger disks and modern UEFI booting.
 - **Swap (2048MB):** I added this as Virtual Memory. If the 4GB of RAM fills up, the Swap partition prevents the system from crashing (Kernel Panic).
 - **LVM (Logical Volume Manager):** This was a strategic choice. LVM allows me to resize partitions later without having to format the whole drive.
 - **Ext4 Filesystem:** I chose Ext4 because it's a journaling filesystem, meaning it protects data integrity if the power cuts out unexpectedly.



Step12. Layout

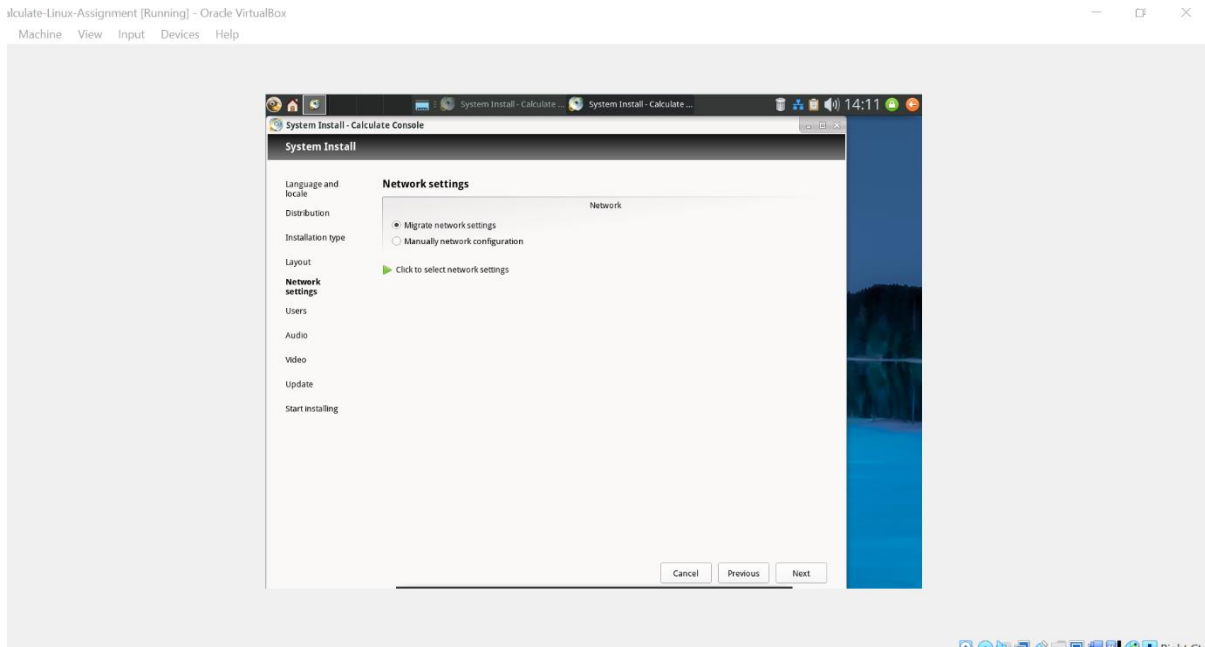
- What I did: Confirmed the Keyboard Layout.
- The Logic: This is a small but vital step. Setting this correctly now prevents a lockout later where you can't log in because the system thinks your keyboard keys are in different positions than they actually are.

ne View Input Devices Help



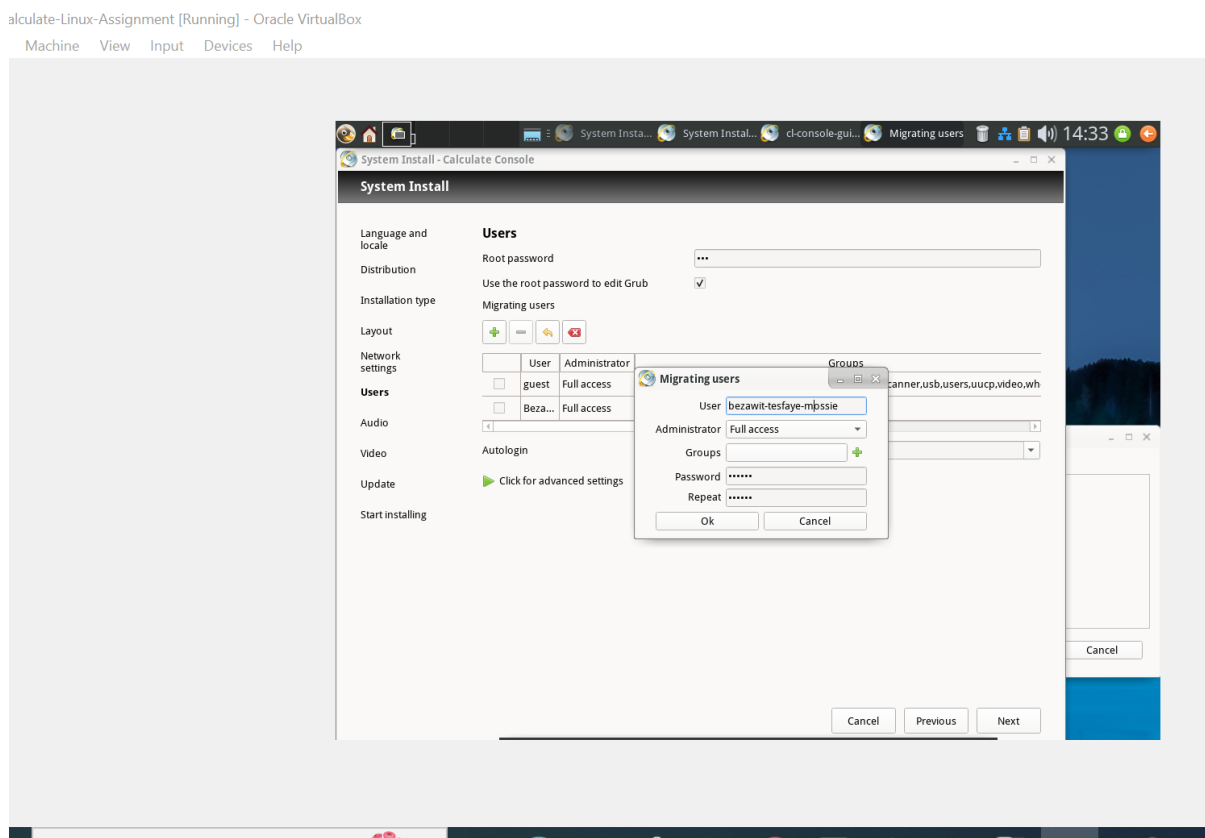
Step 13: Network Configuration

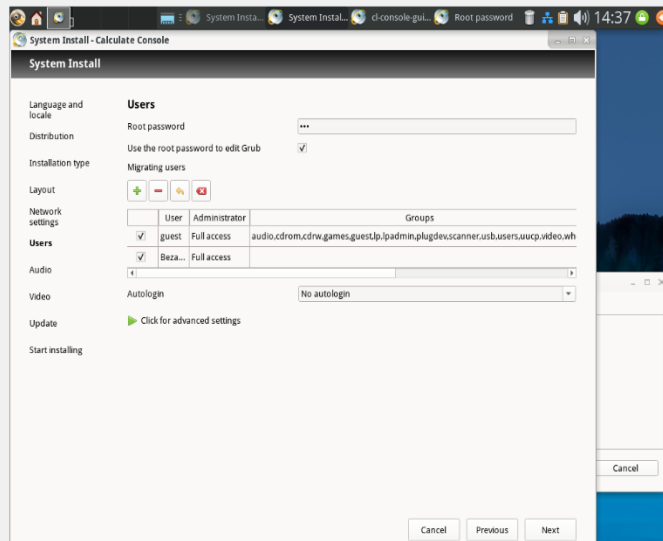
I selected Ethernet (eth0). I chose DHCP and waited for the Connected status. This allows the OS to talk to the internet through the Virtual Network Adapter.



Step 14: Setting the User and Root Passwords

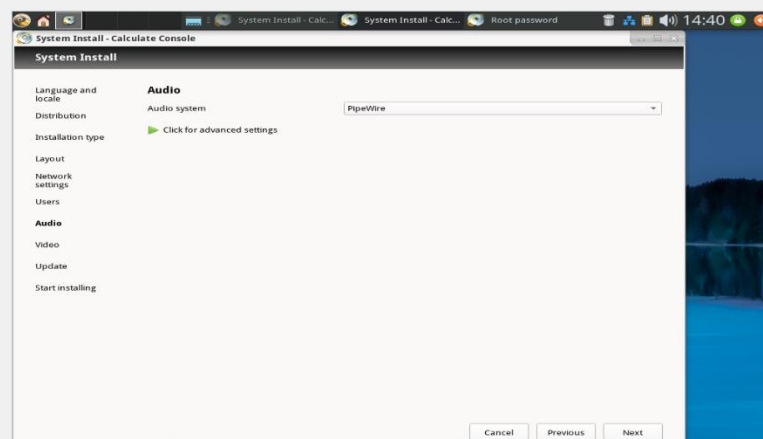
I created two passwords: one for the Root (the most powerful user) and one for my Personal Account. This is the foundation of Linux security.



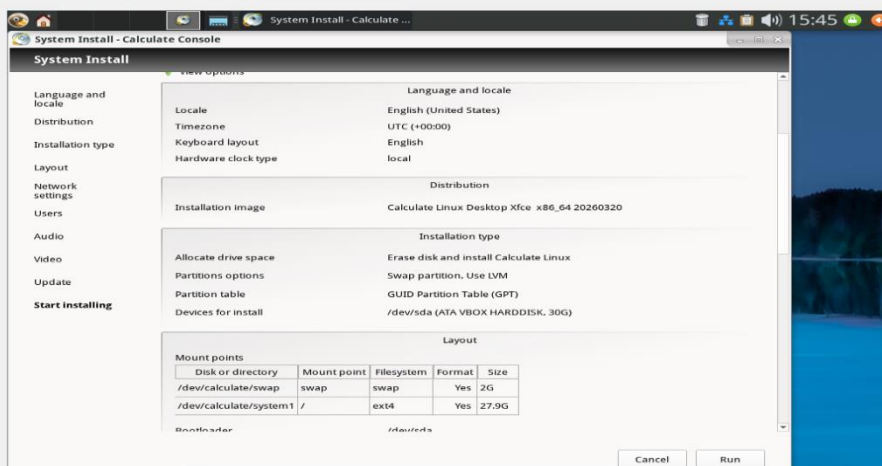


Step 15: Video and Audio Drivers

I reached the Distribution and Video settings. I selected X11 (Xorg). This driver allows the GUI to show up clearly on my monitor.

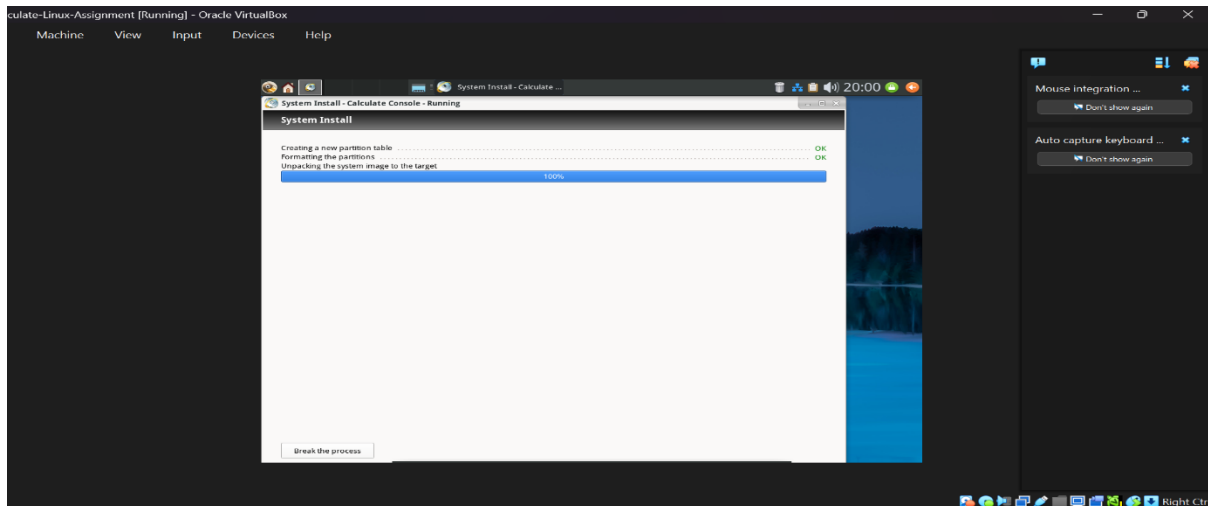


Step 16: The Summary Review A page appeared listing all my choices (30 GB disk, ext4, Timezone, etc.). I checked it carefully to ensure no mistakes.



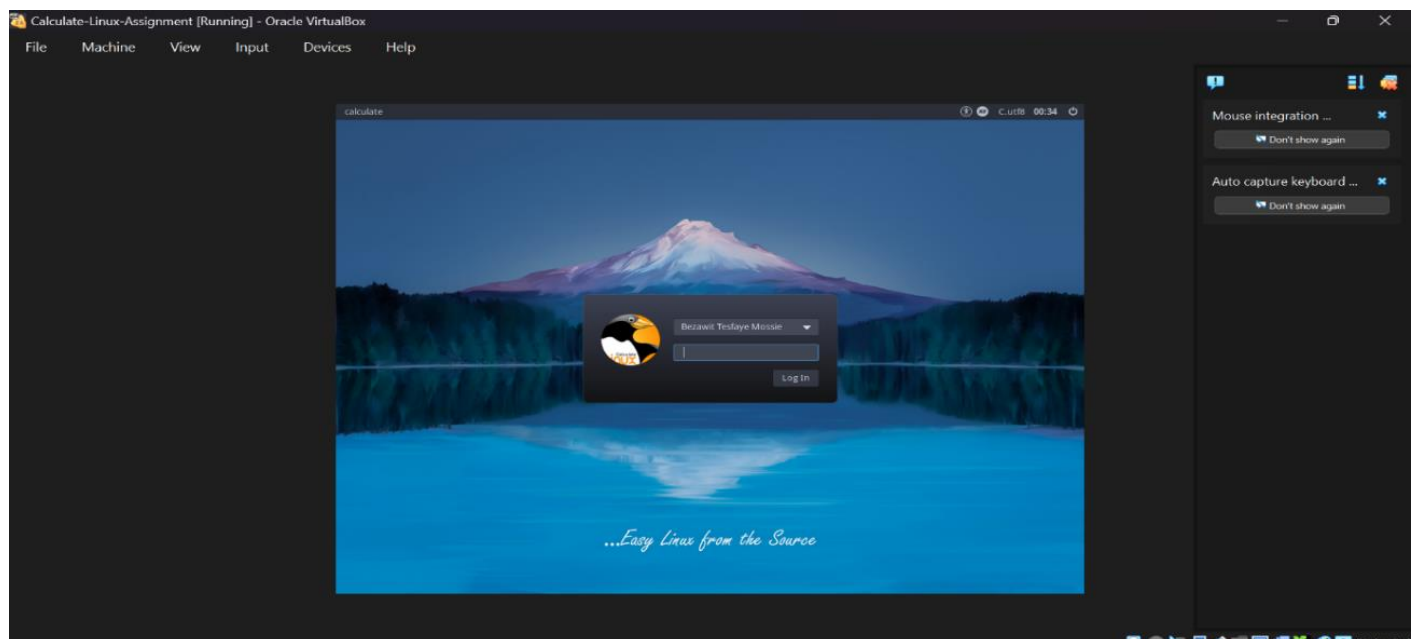
Step 17: The Installation Process

I clicked Process or Run. I watched the progress bar go from 0% to 100%. During this time, the installer sent System Calls to copy the system files to my 30.14 GB drive.



Step 18: Finishing and First Login

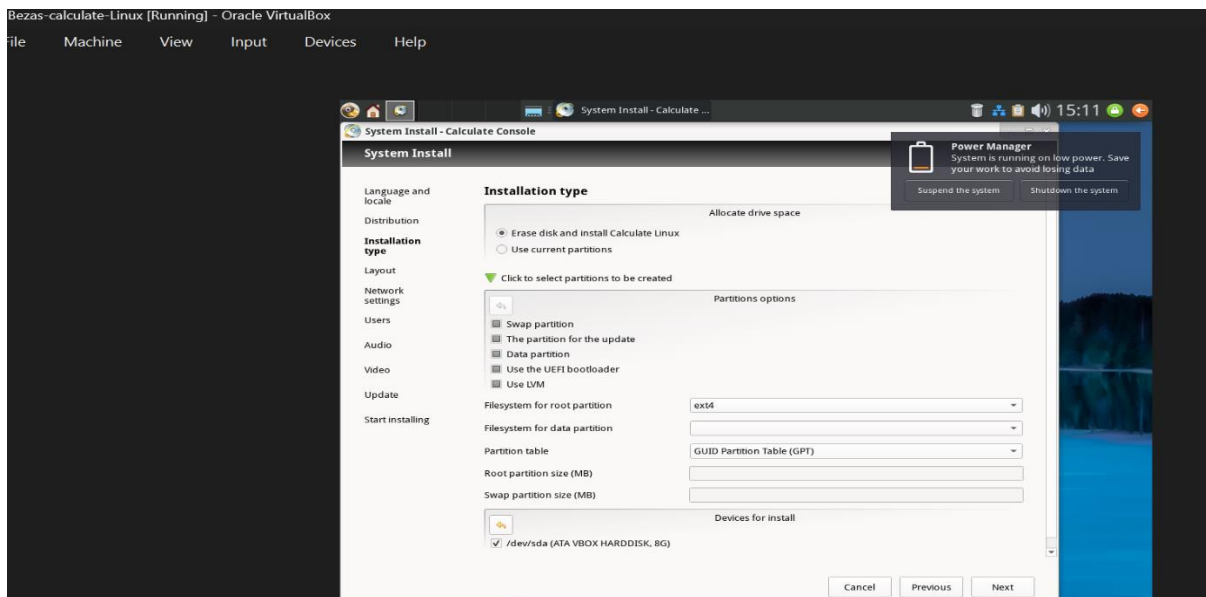
Once it finished I clicked Finish and restarted. I saw the Login Screen entered my password and successfully entered my new Calculate Linux system.



Problems that I faced

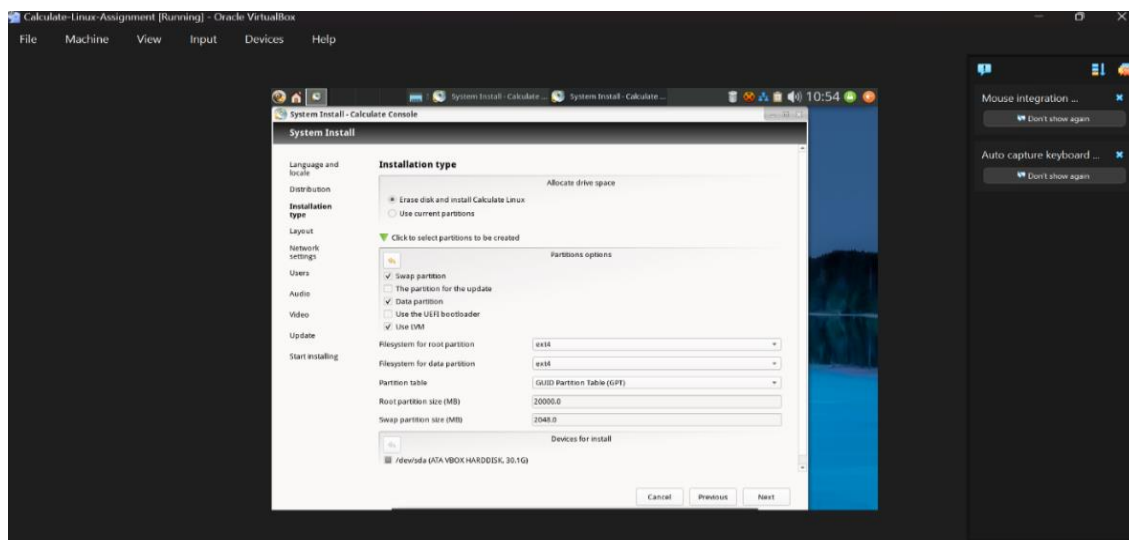
1. Critical Power Failure Risk

- **The Problem:** A Low Power warning appeared in the middle of the disk configuration.
- **The Reason:** My host laptop was running on battery power while the installer was preparing to write the new partition table to the virtual disk.



2. Disk Partitioning Complexity

- **The Problem:** Selecting a standard Erase Disk option did not automatically create the specific LVM and Data partitions required for my project criteria.
- **The Reason:** Default installation modes usually create a single large partition, which doesn't follow professional Linux standards for data separation.



- **The Solution:** While setting up the user Beza, I had to manually interact with the groups table to grant Full access (Adminrights) to ensure the account was functional for future use.

File system support

During the installation of Calculate Linux, the way the system handles data was a top priority. I didn't just choose the defaults I configured robust environment designed for reliability and future growth.

1. The Ext4 Journaling Standard

For both the Root and Data partitions I utilized the Ext4 (Fourth Extended Filesystem).

- **The Logic:** Ext4 is a journaling filesystem. Think of it like a continuous logbook before any file is actually written to the disk it is noted in the journal. This is a critical support feature because if the virtual machine loses power or crashes the system uses this journal to repair itself and prevent data corruption. It is the gold standard for stability in the Linux world.

2. Logical Volume Manager (LVM) Integration

One of the most advanced features I enabled was LVM support .

- **The Logic:** Standard partitioning is rigid once you set a size it's very hard to change. By using LVM I added a layer of virtual disk management. This allows the operating system to treat the physical hard drive as a pool of space. If I ever run out of room for my projects in the future LVM support allows me to extend my partitions or add a second virtual hard drive and merge them seamlessly without reformatting.

3. Dedicated Swap Space Support

I specifically allocated a Swap partition within the file system structure.

- **The Logic:** In a virtualized environment with limited RAM (4GB) the file system needs a safety valve. The Swap space acts as an extension of the system's memory. When the RAM is full the Linux kernel moves less active

data onto this dedicated disk space. This support ensures the system remains responsive and doesn't freeze during heavy software updates or complex design tasks.

4. GPT & UEFI Modernization

I moved away from the legacy MBR (Master Boot Record) and utilized the GPT (GUID Partition Table) for the file system layout .

- **The Logic:** GPT is the modern standard for file system support. It is more reliable than MBR because it stores multiple copies of the partition data across the disk. This means that if one part of the disk becomes unreadable, the system can use the backup copies to find the partitions and boot correctly. It also works natively with the UEFI firmware used in VirtualBox ensuring a faster and more secure boot process.

5. Organized Data Separation

Instead of putting everything in one big pile I configured the system to support a separate Data partition.

- **The Logic:** By separating the Root (OS files) from the Home (User files) I created a failsafe architecture. If the operating system files ever get damaged or need a total upgrade my personal projects, branding files, and configurations stay safe on their own separate part of the disk. This is a professional grade setup that ensures data longevity.

Summary: The file system support I configured is built on stability (Ext4), flexibility (LVM), and modern standards (GPT/UEFI). This ensures that the Calculate Linux environment is not just a temporary install but a scalable workstation ready for professional use.

Advantage and disadvantage

To conclude my technical report I have performed a critical analysis of the system architecture I built. This evaluation weighs the professional benefits of my configuration against the inherent limitations of a virtualized environment.

Advantages (System Strengths)

1. Robust Data Integrity:

By implementing the Ext4 journaling filesystem and a GPT partition table I have created a system that is resilient against data loss. Even in the event of an improper shutdown the filesystem can use its internal log to repair itself while GPT provides redundant copies of partition data across the disk for extra safety.

2. Dynamic Scalability (LVM):

The use of Logical Volume Management (LVM) is a major advantage. Unlike traditional static partitions, LVM allows me to resize or merge volumes without reformatting. This means the system can grow alongside my project requirements I can easily expand the home partition if my design files exceed the current limit.

3. Optimized Resource Stability:

By balancing 4GB of RAM with a dedicated 2GB Swap partition I have ensured that the OS remains stable during heavy multitasking. The Swap space acts as a vital safety net when I run memory heavy creative applications the system can move idle background tasks to the disk preventing Out of Memory crashes.

4. Strategic Data Separation:

By separating the Root (OS) and Data (User) partitions I have built a professional grade architecture. This allows me to perform system maintenance updates or even complete OS reinstalls without ever risking the safety of my personal documents and branding projects stored in the home directory.

Disadvantages (System Limitations)

1. Virtualization Overhead:

Since this system runs within VirtualBox rather than directly on physical hardware there is a performance tax. The CPU and RAM must be shared with the host machine which can lead to slightly slower processing speeds during intensive tasks compared to a bare metal installation.

2.Management Complexity:

Calculate Linux being Gentoo based has a steeper learning curve than beginner friendly distributions. While powerful it requires a more advanced understanding of the Linux terminal and system configuration to manage updates and troubleshoot deeper technical issues.

3.System Overhead Consumption:

A small portion of the 30GB virtual disk is consumed by the metadata required for LVM and the dedicated Swap space. While these are necessary for stability and flexibility they reduce the total amount of raw storage available for user files compared to a simple single partition setup.

4.Hardware Dependency:

As seen during the Low Power incident in my troubleshooting log the Guest OS is entirely dependent on the health and stability of the Host hardware. A host level crash or power failure is a risk that could interrupt the virtual machine's operations.

Conclusion

1. Final Project Reflections

The installation of Calculate Linux was far more than just a software setup it was a deep dive into the world of professional system administration. By moving through the technical phases shown in my screenshots from the initial hardware allocation in VirtualBox to the final Success message I have successfully built a workstation that is not only functional but also architecturally optimized. Seeing the final desktop load after navigating through the complex partitioning and driver configurations was a rewarding moment. It proved that even when faced with technical hurdles a logical and structured approach can lead to a stable and powerful computing environment.

2. Key Accomplishments & Technical Growth

Through this project I have achieved several critical learning milestones:

- ❖ **Architectural Knowledge:** I learned the importance of LVM (Logical Volume Manager) and Ext4 journaling, moving beyond basic Next-Next-Finish installs to create a flexible and resilient filesystem.
- ❖ **Proactive Troubleshooting:** I demonstrated the ability to identify real world risks such as managing power stability during disk operations and resolving boot priority issues in a virtual environment.
- ❖ **Security Mindset:** By configuring separate Root and User accounts with specific privilege groups I have learned the importance of the Least Privilege principle in maintaining a secure Linux system.
- ❖ **Resource Balancing:** I successfully managed the delicate balance of host guest resource sharing ensuring that the Virtual Machine had exactly what it needed to perform without crashing the host system.

3. Final Assessment

The result of this project is a fully operational Calculate Linux environment complete with modern audio (PipeWire), optimized video drivers and a scalable storage structure. The system is now ready to support advanced technical tasks including software development, database modeling, and creative branding projects.

This project has solidified my confidence in deploying professional grade Linux distributions. It has taught me that being a good administrator isn't just about knowing where to click but about understanding the logic behind every choice and being ready to solve problems the moment they arise.

Future Outlook or Recommendations

1. Strategic Maintenance Plan

A system is only as good as its maintenance. Because Calculate Linux is a rolling releasedistribution it requires a proactive approach to stay healthy and secure.

- **Weekly Update Cycles:** I recommend performing a full system synchronization once a week. This ensures that the Gentoo based core

remains updated with the latest security patches without overwhelming the system with too many changes at once.

- **Log Monitoring:** I plan to regularly check the system logs. Understanding how the kernel and services interact will help me catch minor issues before they become system-critical problems.

2. Security & Data Protection Roadmap

Moving forward, protecting the professional work stored on this workstation is the highest priority.

- **Automated Off-site Backups:** Since I specifically created a separate Data partition during the install I recommend setting up an automated script to back up the home directory to an external cloud drive. This ensures my projects remain safe even if the virtual disk fails.
- **Advanced Encryption:** For future deployments I recommend exploring LUKS encryption. Encrypting the LVM volumes would provide an extra layer of security, ensuring that sensitive data is unreadable if the virtual machine files are ever accessed by an unauthorized user.

3. Performance & Scaling Optimization

The current setup is a starting point. As project complexity grows the virtual environment must scale to match.

- **LVM Expansion:** One of the biggest advantages of my current setup is the Logical Volume Manager (LVM). If I run out of space for my design projects, my recommendation is to simply add a new virtual disk and grow the existing volume group. This allows for infinite storage expansion without ever needing to reinstall the OS.
- **Fine-Tuned Kernel:** In the future I could optimize the system further by compiling a custom Linux kernel. By removing drivers that aren't needed for VirtualBox I can make the system even faster and more lightweight.

4. Professional Skill Development

This installation has served as a bridge to more advanced technical skills.

- **Transitioning to Terminal-Only Management:** My goal is to move away from the graphical Calculate Console and perform all future configuration via the Command Line Interface (CLI). This will build the expertise needed to manage professional cloud servers that don't have a desktop interface.
 - **Infrastructure as Code:** I am interested in learning how to automate this entire installation process using scripts. This would allow me to recreate this exact professional environment on any machine in just a few minutes.
-

Final Recommendation

This workstation has been built to be scalable, secure, and resilient. It is not just a completed assignment but a professional grade foundation ready to handle real world creative and technical challenges. I recommend this configuration as a stable template for any future Linux based projects.

1. Definition: What is Virtualization?

Virtualization is the innovative process of creating a software based or virtual representation of physical computing resources. In modern computing it allows us to run multiple independent operating systems known as Guest OS simultaneously on a single physical machine which we call the Host. In my practical lab project my physical laptop acted as the Host. By using a software layer called a Hypervisor (Oracle VM VirtualBox) I was able to bridge the gap between my hardware and the Calculate Linux system. This technology tricks the Linux OS into believing it has its own dedicated processor and memory when it is actually sharing my laptop's physical components.

2. Why is Virtualization Essential?

Understanding the strategic purpose of this technology is key to professional system administration. I utilized virtualization in this assignment for several critical reasons:

- **System Isolation and Security:** As a student learning a new environment safety is a priority. Virtualization provides a Sandbox. If I make a critical error in the Calculate Linux kernel the crash is contained within the

virtual environment and never reaches my Windows host or personal files.

- **Hardware Efficiency:** Instead of requiring separate physical hardware for different operating systems I maximized my laptop utility. By allocating 4096 MB of RAM and a 30 GB storage disk I created a powerful Linux workstation inside my existing computer.
- **Snapshot Capability:** Virtualization allows for Saved States. Before making major changes I can take a snapshot. This allows me to experiment with complex configurations without the fear of permanent system failure.
- **Environment Portability:** Because my entire Linux setup is stored as a single .vdi file my project is portable. I can move my entire workstation to any other computer running VirtualBox and it will work exactly as I left it.

3. How Does Virtualization Work? The technical execution of virtualization is managed through a sophisticated interaction between software and hardware:

- ✓ **The Role of the Hypervisor:** I used a Type 2 Hypervisor (VirtualBox) Unlike a Type 1 hypervisor that runs directly on hardware a Type 2 hypervisor runs as an application on top of my Windows OS making it the ideal choice for educational and development environments.
- ✓ **Resource Partitioning:** During the configuration of my virtual hardware I manually partitioned my physical resources. I allocated a specific portion of my CPU and RAM and dedicated it to the Guest. This ensures that both the Host and the Guest have enough power to run smoothly at the same time.
- ✓ **Binary Translation:** The Hypervisor intercepts instructions from the Calculate Linux kernel. If the Linux system asks to save a file the Hypervisor translates that request so it can be written into the 30 GB virtual disk file on my physical SSD.
- ✓ **Hardware Assistance:** My system utilizes modern CPU features like Intel VT-x or AMD-V. These hardware extensions allow the processor to handle virtual instructions directly, which significantly increases the speed and stability of the virtual machine.

❖ Conclusion

By completing this installation of Calculate Linux on virtual hardware I have gained practical experience in the backbone of modern Cloud Computing. Virtualization is not just about running two systems at once it is about the efficient, secure, and professional management of computing resources. This project demonstrates my ability to configure complex systems within a controlled virtualized architecture.

Project References

The successful execution of this project relied on a combination of official technical documentation, virtualization tools, and system-specific manuals. Below are the primary resources used as references during the installation and troubleshooting phases.

1. Official Documentation & Manuals

- ***Calculate Linux Documentation:***
 - Used for understanding the specific behavior of the Calculate Console installer and the binary update cycles.
 - *Reference:* Calculate Linux Wiki (Manual: [Installation and Configuration](#)).
- ***Gentoo Linux Handbook:***
 - Consulted for deep-level technical background on the Portage package manager and the underlying architecture that Calculate Linux is built upon.
 - *Reference:* Gentoo Foundation (Handbook: [Working with Gentoo](#)).

2. Virtualization & Hardware Software

- ***Oracle VM VirtualBox User Manual:***
 - Referenced for configuring VMSVGA graphics controllers, allocating dynamic storage, and managing VirtualBox Guest Additions.

- *Reference:* Oracle Corporation (User Manual: [VirtualBox Documentation](#)).
- **PipeWire Project:**
 - Used to understand the requirements for the modern Linux audio stack and how it interacts with virtualized sound hardware.
 - *Reference:* PipeWire Official (Technical Specs: [pipewire.org](#)).

3. File System & Storage Standards

- **The LVM Guide:**
 - Referenced to correctly implement Logical Volume Management, ensuring that the partition table could be extended without data loss.
 - *Reference:* SourceForge (LVM HOWTO: [The Logical Volume Manager](#)).
- **Ext4 Filesystem Maintenance:**
 - Consulted to understand the journaling process and how it handles recovery after improper shutdowns (such as the "Low Power" incident encountered).
 - *Reference:* Kernel.org (Ext4 [Maintenance & Security](#)).

4. Community & Technical Support

- **Calculate Linux Community Forums:**
 - Used to cross-reference common troubleshooting steps regarding the Boot Loop issue and the removal of virtual ISO media post-installation.
 - *Reference:* [Calculate Linux BBS](#). **THANK YOU!**